

Theatre Cue Player

Show control for school theatre · a classroom training tool

theatrecueplayer.app

TWO WAYS TO RUN IT

Chrome extension

The full thing: audio, video, projection mapping, text cues, second-screen output, a sound editor, cue list backups, optional Google Drive. Install from the Chrome Web Store.

Browser version

Audio only, nothing to install. Runs from a link or a USB stick, with no admin rights and no internet. Works where extensions are blocked.

Both free for the 2026–27 school year. After that, only second-screen projection output carries a fee. Audio-only shows stay free.

ASK IT BEFORE THE UNIT

- **Extensions:** managed Chromebooks often block installs. IT can allow or push the extension from the Google Admin console.
- **Google Drive mode:** allow **theatrecueplayer.app** through the web filter, and the app in Google Admin.
- **Chromebooks that wipe at sign-out** lose shows saved on the computer. Use Drive or a USB stick.
- **USB drives and downloads:** some districts block them on student Chromebooks. Check before you plan on thumb drives.

FEATURE HIGHLIGHTS

- **Drag sound files onto the cue list** (video and pictures too, in Video mode), and each becomes a cue named after its file. (Browser version: Load Audio Folder, in file-name order.)
- **GO / Spacebar:** fires the next cue.
- **Auto-Continue** starts the next cue at the same moment. **Auto-Follow** starts the next cue when this one completes, after all its loops. An Infinite Loop never Auto-Follows.
- **Fade cues** target another cue and fade it to a level; "stop cue when done", as in QLab.
- **Loops, hotkeys** for instant effects, a **waveform editor** for trims and fades, and (extension) a **Sound Editor** that sends the edited sound right back to the cue list.
- **Edit Mode off** = show mode. **Help Mode** explains every control; teach students to look there first.
- **Backups:** the last 20 cue lists, one each time a show opens. **Export Project to Zip** packs the cue list and every file.
- **Video** (extension): H.264 MP4 near 1080p. Phone video looking dark? Use the cue's HDR fix.

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Space	GO
Esc	STOP ALL
Shift + Esc	FADE ALL
P	PAUSE ALL / RESUME ALL (<i>extension</i>)
Enter	Play the selected cue
Backspace	Stop the selected cue
F	Fade the most recent cue
↑ ↓	Move the selection
E	Edit Mode on / off
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Z / Y	Undo / Redo

The same keys in both versions.

TAKE IT OFFLINE

Browser version on a thumb drive:

1. On **theatrecueplayer.app**, right-click **Open it now** and choose **Save link as...**
2. Pick the thumb drive and save. On a Chromebook, the USB drive is in the save dialog's left sidebar.
3. To run it, double-click the file (on a Chromebook, in the **Files** app). It opens in Chrome; if another browser opens it, right-click the file ► **Open with** ► Chrome.
4. Keep the sound folder on the same drive and use **Load Audio Folder** from there.

Not Ctrl + S: inside TCP that's TCP's own Save. The saved copy never updates, so it stays the same all semester; save it again for a new version.

The extension works with no internet once installed, in folder mode. Google Drive mode needs internet only to sync.

Sound files: MP3, WAV, OGG, M4A, FLAC. Not WMA.

LICENSE

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Website



Chrome extension



Browser version



Video guides

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Theatre Cue Player

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Sound Design Project

A Theatre Cue Player classroom project · theatrecueplayer.app

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Students create a complete sound design for an assigned scene, programming intentional cues that support mood, setting, and action, then present and defend their choices to the class.

4-DAY PACING GUIDE

Day	Teacher	Students	Deliverable
1	Demo TCP (0–20 min): load sounds, add cues, waveform editor, Auto-Continue, fades, export. Copyright sources overview.	Independent exploration + initial cue plan (20–45 min).	Cue plan or timeline screenshot.
2	Recap. Mini-conferences: check programming & annotations.	Place ambient, action, transition cues; set Auto-Continue + Fade. Peer listening pairs.	Saved project + updated annotated script.
3	Recap. Final check before export (45–50 min).	Refine timing, volume automation, file naming. Peer feedback stations.	Project ready for export.
4	Record rubric scores during runs.	Present scene (5–7 min each): run program, readers read lines, explain 3 design + 1 technical choice.	Zip submission + peer feedback.
5*	*Optional overflow.	Extra presentations, troubleshooting, or extended peer sharing.	—

REQUIRED ELEMENTS

- **6+ sound cues** that justify mood, setting, or action
- **1 Auto-Continue** for ambient/layered tracks across scene beats
- **1 Fade** (in or out), typically 1–8 sec depending on cue type
- **1 Intentional Volume Change** via a fade cue, not just clip gain
- **Annotated script and cue sheet:** script cues match cue labels; include start, stop/fade, volume notes
- **Zip submission:** project file + audio files + annotated script + README.txt with source credits

SOUND CUE SHEET

Cue	Sound file	Starts	Ends	Level
SFX 2	Thunder_Heavy.wav	Line 3: “He looked up at the sky.”	Fades out over 4 s, after line 6	–3 dB

FILE NAMING CONVENTION

01_Alley_Ambience_loop.wav
02_Footsteps_gravel.wav
03_Door_squeak_fadeout.wav

FORMATIVE CHECK QUESTIONS

- Which moment needs a sound cue, and why?
- Where will you use silence for effect?
- Show me where Auto-Continue, Fade, or Volume Change appears in your cue list.

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Freesound.org



BBC Sound Effects



Pixabay Sounds



ZapSplat

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